apartment before nightfall. She would make a cup of linden tea. It was better than the terrible *Kaffee-Mix* served here, which was more roasted peas and barley than coffee. It was time to put the past behind her, and accept that she'd lost her sister the day she stepped out of the car. Forty-five years was too long.

Rose slid the chair back. She heard the door to the café open, as she was returning the sketchbooks to her bag. She stood and rechecked her watch: noon. Time to go. She reached across the chair for her cane.

She was stepping away from the table, the bag over her shoulder, when two women approached. Rose's throat tightened. They were tall, confident, and beautiful—as if summer itself had walked into the café. She gripped the edge of the table, bracing herself as her head began to spin. It was them. Léa's daughters.

"Rose?" the taller one said.

Rose recognized Nadiya's deep, dark eyes. "Katya?"

"Yes. How did you know? This is—"

"Eve, Josef's daughter," Rose said, her voice catching in her throat. The memory of him brought sudden tears to her eyes. She stared at the girl. "Your mother's right—you have exactly the same light in your eyes that your father had."

Eve stepped closer with a bright look and a smile across her face. "Tell me about him."

"He was a wonderful, caring man. He loved your mother very much." Rose couldn't take her eyes off the two women and kept glancing back and forth between them, noticing bits of Josef in Eve and Nadiya in Katya. "Won't you sit down? Would you like a drink?"

They pulled out their chairs, Eve taking the one on her left, Katya on her right.

"We can't stay long," Katya said, tilting her head toward the door.

"I'm glad you've come." Rose leaned her cane against the table. "I've something I want to give to you both, something I think belongs to you, not me."

"Photos?" Eve leaned forward. "Maman doesn't have a single one of Papa. I'd love to see him."

Rose pulled out all four sketch books from her bag.

"Photo albums?" Eve asked excitedly.